

Gmail

Eversince Google began its Gmail service, it has transformed the way we have interacted. Within a span of two years, Google has enhanced its customer base to over 170 million users. Its user interface is mostly self-descriptive and you'll find yourself at ease with most functions, but there are several other features that improve functionality to a very large extent.

Priority Inbox

The latest feature Gmail has introduced is the new Priority Inbox. It targeted and incorporated multiple features from Google Labs into the primary Gmail UI. We recommend this new feature, especially if you receive large volume of incoming mail.

Priority Inbox promises to segregate your email into important and not so important, so that you don't have to waste unnecessary time.

The Priority Inbox works off algorithms that keep track of user choices and deciphers a relevant pattern in terms of importance in all incoming email. Based on this data and existing trends, it fixes priority for each incoming email. The



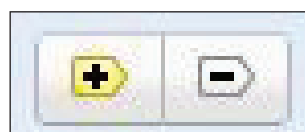
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sections under Priority Inbox. Google employees report that such an interface saved about 13 per cent of their time.

For Priority Inbox to function efficiently it has to learn your preferences initially where you have to mark your mail either as important or not important. This is carried out by the two buttons that get added to the Gmail tool panel after enabling Priority Inbox. The yellow button with a '+'

mails, consistent mail content and predefined filters

The Priority Inbox has a certain degree of flexibility. After a user chooses to enable the Priority Inbox, an additional tab appears in the Google settings panel. The user is given the option to:



Mark your email as Important by clicking on the + sign

select Priority Mailbox as the default mailbox, disable priority inbox completely, override filters, or include all mails under a single label.

Search queries

Say, you have postponed reading a lot of mail and have read a few in between and left many unread. Gmail only has 100 conversations per page but your unread items are scattered in subsequent pages. To be able to view all your unread mail at once, use the search query `label:unread` in the search box on top of the Gmail page. Similarly, appending queries such as `is:starred`, `is:unread`, `is:read` and `is:chat` can be used within Gmail to sort through starred, unread, read and chat message respectively. For example a search query like `in:trash is:unread` searches for all unread mail presently in the trash folder.

You can also search messages with tags like from, to, subject and folder. Use of operators such as OR is also allowed. For example `from:digit OR to:digit after:2010/04/02` searches for all mail sent to, and received from digit after April 2, 2010. The | character can also be used in place of OR. The search term followed by `in:foldername` will search for your search term only within the folder specified. Default folders include Inbox, Trash, Spam, and Sent Folder.



One of Gmail's most efficient functions is its search

important mails are tagged and occupy the uppermost segment of your mailbox. Mail gets segregated into Important and unread, Starred and Everything else. Apart from these three default sections, you also have the ability to customise

sign marks a mail as important. The white button with a '-' sign deselects an important mail. The algorithm's efficiency is dependent on the usage of this feature. The degree of relevance shall get better only with a larger number of incoming



Priority Inbox saves you a lot of valuable time

Security options

Gmail always keeps a log of your activity. So if you are suspecting somebody of hacking into or logging into your



Make alterations to your Priority Inbox from the Settings page